

382. Photos of shards from Jelamet el-Ahmar (A): 1. ledge handle, red slip; 2-3. HM jars.



Site 179: 18 – 18/91/3

Jelamet el-Ahmar (B)

Israel grid: 1893 1815

UTM grid: 5684 7377

Elevation: 55 m b.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small site

Area: 4 dunams (1 acre)

Topography: ridge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Colluvial-Alluvial;

quality: 7

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 0.3 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 0.6
km distant

Visibility: 2

May 19, 1982; 44 shards and 96 flint
items

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A site on a narrow ridge in a ravine descending to Wadi el-Far'ah, some 0.5 km west of Jelamet el-Ahmar (A). The site is situated south of the wadi.

Remains of a structure, built of small pebbles, are in the center of the ridge, with two or three steps on the slope. No other structural remains are discerned but many stone items, flint of various types and shards. Among them were

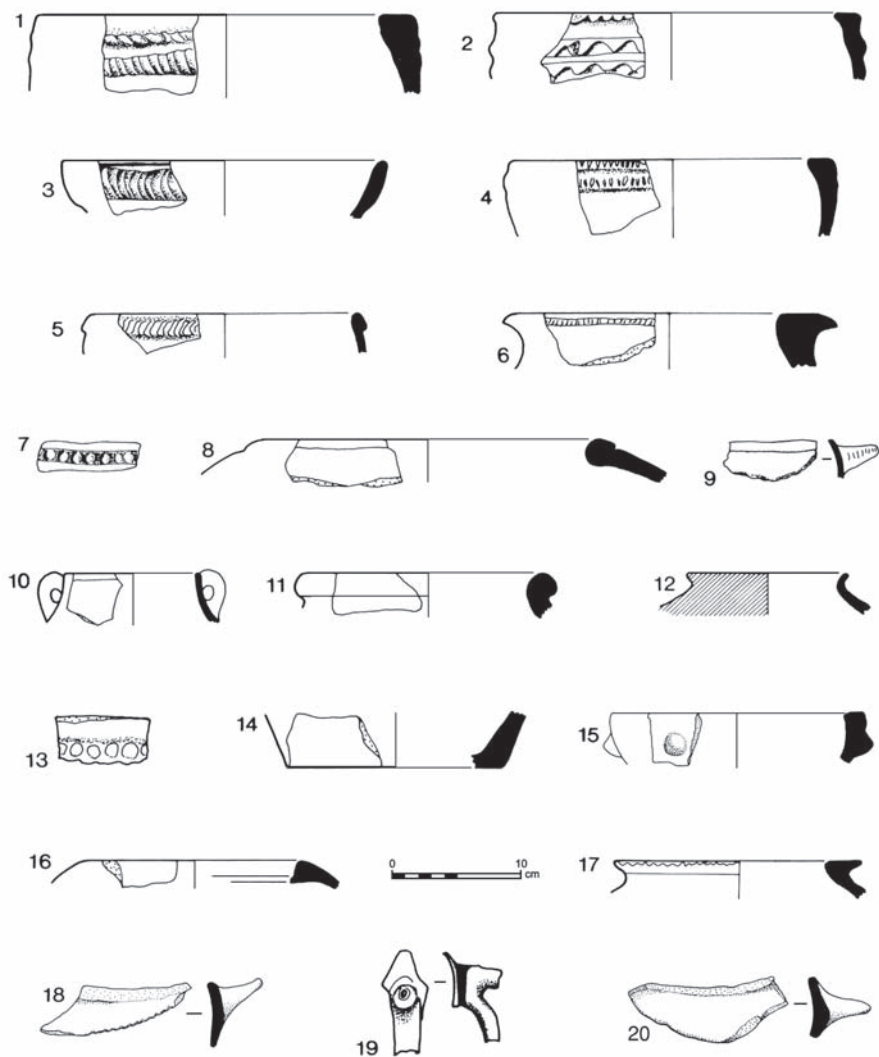
sculpted and worked stones and broad flint adzes.

Pottery: Pottery Neolithic – 70%;
Chal – EBA I – 30%.

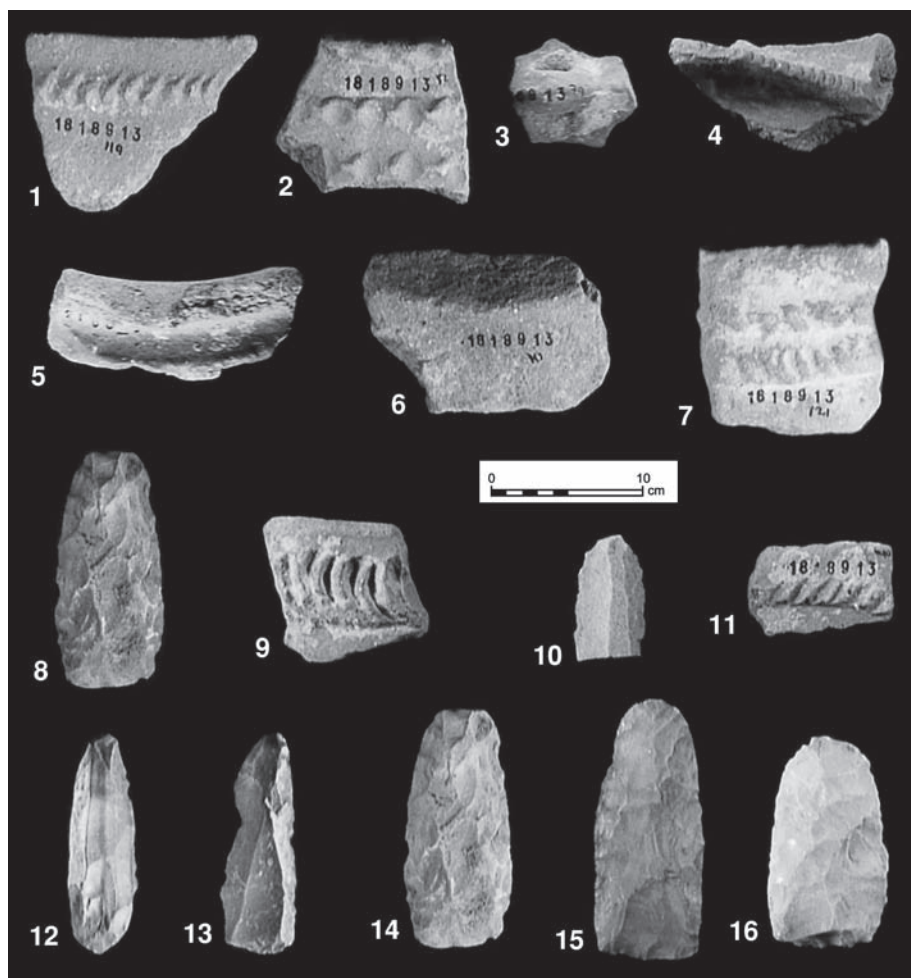
Flint find: Pottery Neolithic, Chal and EBA I; see appendix.

Special find: fragment of statue bottom (?), red; smooth basalt stone with cut, depicting female sexual organ.

Previous surveys: none.



383. Pottery from Jelamet el-Ahmar (B): nos. 10, 12, 17 – Neol; the rest – ‘Far’ah family’: 1-6. Bowls with rope dec, lt br; 7, 13, 17, Dec; 8. HM jar, br; 9, 18, 20. Serrated ledge handles; 10. Small jar, br; 11. Jar, br; 12. Small jar, red slip; 14. Jar base; 15. Bowl with embossed dec, lt br; 16. HM jar; 17. Jar; 19. Handle.



384. Photos of pottery and flint tools from Jelamet el-Ahmar (B).



385. A view from the southwest of the site of Jelamet el-Ahmar (B), on the ridge above the cypress tree. The orchards of Wadi el-Far'ah are to the left; in the background is Ras Bilam ez-Zef. Behind is the hill of Jelamet el-Ahmar (A). Spring 1982.



Site 180: 19 – 18/01/1

Tel Shibli (on SWP map: Shibleh; on new maps: Kh. Bab en-Naqb)

Israel grid: 1901 1819
 UTM grid: 7284 5689
 Elevation: 57 m b.s.l., 15 m a.s.a.
 Name type: historical site on map
 Site type: tell
 Area: 6 dunams (1.5 acres)
 Topography: ridge edge, valley edge and hilltop
 Rock type: Judah formation
 Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;

quality: 8
 Cultivation: field crops
 Cisterns: none
 Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), passes by site
 Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), passes by site
 Visibility: 3
 May 24, 1982; 63 shards

A tell in the valley of Wadi el-Far'ah, adjacent to it and to the spring of

'Ain Shibli. The tell is connected by a saddle to the ridge on the north-

west, and is protected on the east by Wadi en-Naqb.

On top of the tell is a square structure, 40x40 m in size, built of earthen rampart 6 m wide. A similar rampart on the perimeter of the tell may have marked the surrounding wall. The road to the Jordan Valley has cut a deep cross-section in the tell, where remnants of walls and floors are visible. On the surface of the tell there are remains of many more walls, with broad expanses of looting in the north. Here, there

is an abundance of Byzantine Period shards. Porath suggested that a pottery workshop stood there. A new Bedouin settlement was in the northwest of the tell during our visit (1982).

Pottery: EBA I – 20%; EBA II – 10%; MBA I – 30%; IrA II – 2%; LR – 8%; Byz – 20%; EM – 10%.

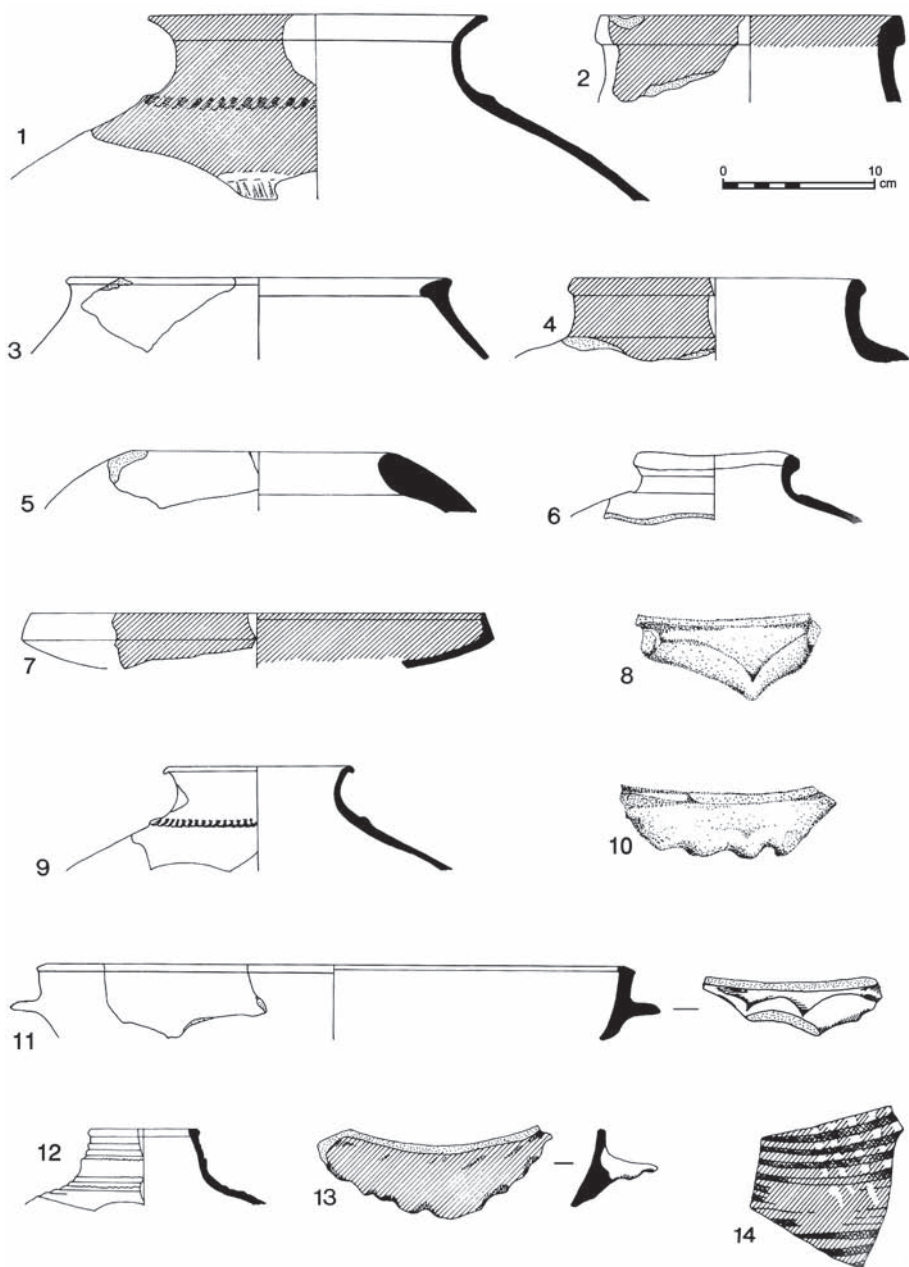
Flint: 'Canaanite blade' from the Bronze Age.

Special find: Basalt weights.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 159.



386. Aerial photo of Tel Shibli, looking southeast. To its left is Wadi Bab en-Naqb; behind it are the orchards of Wadi el-Far'ah and the road to the Jordan Valley. Winter 1992.



387. Pottery from Tel Shibli: nos. 2, 4-5, 7 – EBA I-II; 1, 3, 10-11, 13 – MBA I; 6, 12, 14 – Byz; 1, 9. Jars, gray slip, rope dec; 2, 4. Jars, red slip; 3. Crater, gray; 5. HM jar, yel; 6. Jar, br; 7. Platter, red slip; 8, 10, 13. Ledge handles, yel; 11. Bowl, yel; 12. Jar, dk; 14. Section of jar, wh dec on bl.

Site 181: 19 – 18/01/2

‘Ain Shibli

Israel grid: 1904 1817

UTM grid: 7287 5685

Elevation: 55 m b.s.l., 5 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: large ruin and shard scatter

Area: 20 dunams (5 acres)

Topography: valley edge and slope

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;

quality: 6

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far‘ah
(no. 104), 0.2 km distant

Nearest road: Far‘ah – Jiftliq (B3),
passes by site

Visibility: 2

May 24, 1982; 31 shards

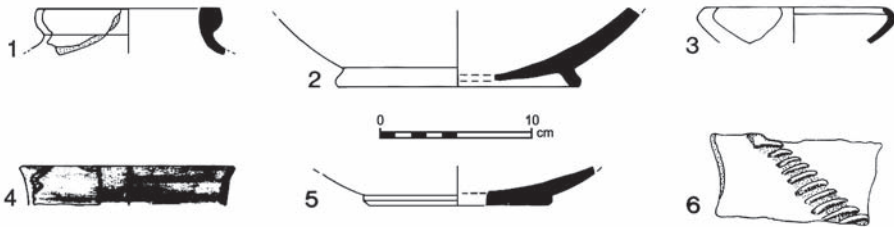
A site on a slope near Wadi el-Far‘ah, in the foothills of the northern and next to the Jordan Valley road. A new Bedouin settlement is built on the site.

Many shards were found on the slopes, some concentrated in groups. The various walls do not create structures, and the site was

possibly an extension of the fortified tell nearby.

Pottery: EBA I – 20%; MBA IIB – 30%; Hel – 30%; Byz – 20%.

Previous surveys: none. The site may have been surveyed by Porath (1968, no. 85), who called it Kh. Tahunet et-Tirah.



388. Pottery from ‘Ain Shibli: 1. Jar, lt, Hel; 2. Bowl base ,yel, MBA II; 3. Small bowl, lt Hel; 4. Small bowl, red slip, EBA; 5. Bowl base, lt ,MBA II ; 6. Rope dec, br, EBA I.

Site 182: 18 – 18/61/1

Mughur 'Id

Israel grid: 1861 1810

UTM grid: 7254 5677

Elevation: 350 m a.s.l., 200 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small ruin

Area: 4.8 dunams (1.2 acres)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Kurnub formation

Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;
quality: 6

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain
Mughur 'Id, no. 108), 0.2 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 2.2
km distant

Visibility: 8

Feb. 13, 1983; 62 shards and four
flint items

* * *

A site on a low hilltop, on the middle step south and above the valley of Wadi el-Far'ah. South of the site rise the cliffs of Tell el-Fukhar. From the cliff to the site there is a well-built pass (*naqb*) with hewn

steps. There is a fine view of the river valley.

A surrounding wall on the west, one stone wide, may have been a fortification. Next to it is a large structure and another in the south,



390. View from Mughur 'Id of western Wadi el-Far'ah, with Jebel Tammun above it. 1984.

round. In the north and east there are no walls. Few walls *in situ* and many shards are on the hilltop.

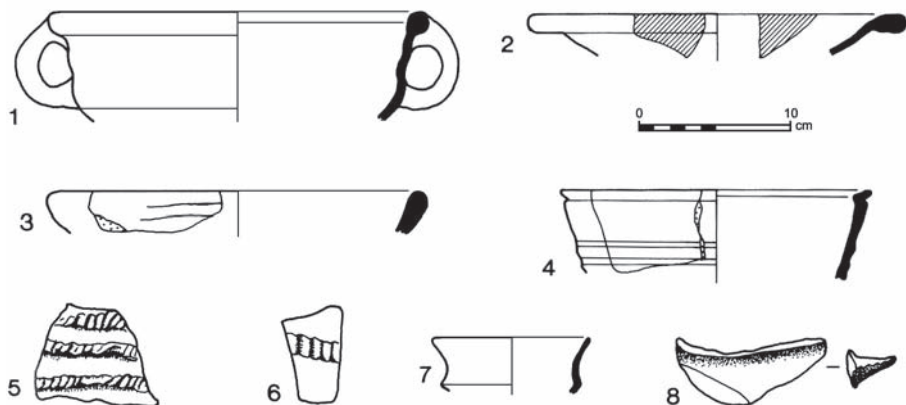
In the ravine to the northeast is a spring ('Ain Mughur 'Id, on the 50.000 map - 'Ain Za'anuni) – the water source of the site. Apparently

the wall is no related to the shard scatter.

Pottery: EBA I – 90% (with some Iron Age and Byz shards).

Flint: Three items from the Early Bronze Age; see appendix.

Previous surveys: none.



391. Pottery from Mughur 'Id, all EBA I, except for nos. 1, 4: 1. Bowl, br, IrA II; 2. Bowl, red slip; 3. Bowl, yel; 4. Bowl, dk, Byz; 5-6. Rope dec, br; 7. Small bowl, yel; 8. Ledge handle, br.



Site 183: 18 – 18/60/1

Tel Za'anuni

Israel grid: 1866 1802

UTM grid: 7259 5667

Elevation: 442 m a.s.l., 300 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: fortified tell

Area: 26 dunams (6.5 acres)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;
quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain Za'anuni, no. 106), 0.2 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 3 km distant

Visibility: 9

Feb. 13, 1983; Apr. 14, 1987; Dec. 10, 1993; 122 shards and nine flint items

A fortified tell on the eastern edge of a small plain, on the upper step above the Wadi el-Far'ah valley and north of Jebel Kebir. 'Ain Za'anuni, the water source, is 0.2 km to the northwest. There is a fine view of the Wadi el-Far'ah environs.

The site consists of four parts:

1. *The lower city* is in the south of the site. This is an irregular long triangle, 15 dunams (3.75 acres), in area, situated on a small plateau delineated by cliffs in the south, east and north. To its west rise the upper city (tell or "acropolis"). Along the edge of the slope, on the southern side, a wall 2-3 m wide, built of medium-sized stones is discerned. In its midway in the south the wall forms a kind of "bay", presumably

the location of the gate. Although the wall is missing in the east and north, it seems to exist there as well. On the surface there is a rich scatter of shards but only few walls *in situ*.

2. *The upper city* is the hilltop tell, about 15 dunams (3.75 acres) in area, located north and above of the lower city. It composes of three main, built terraces descending eastward. On the summit there are remains of structures and a possible fortification wall, while the wall of the lower city comes from the south and connects to the eastern part of the tell.

3. *The industrial area* north of the tell. Here there are many installations, including two oil presses and several basins. It seems that



392. View from the south to the lower city of Tel Za'anuni. 1983.

in this area there was an extensive activity of processing agricultural products, mainly during the Byzantine Period – judging by the pottery and type of installations. This must have occurred when the tell itself was sparsely settled. A built road also leads to this area.

4. 4. *The cemetery* is located on the hilltop and the slopes west of the tell. Several dozen burial systems are here (1993), most of them under heavy looting. Each system consists of one central hall with caves, mostly with entrance-shaft and sometimes with steps. The dump outside the tombs contains a rich pottery collection, which rep-

resents the settlement periods of the site.

Pottery: Pottery Neolithic – 5%; Chal – 10%; EBA I – 25%; EBA II – 40%; MBA IIB – 5%; IrA II – 10%; Byz – 5%.

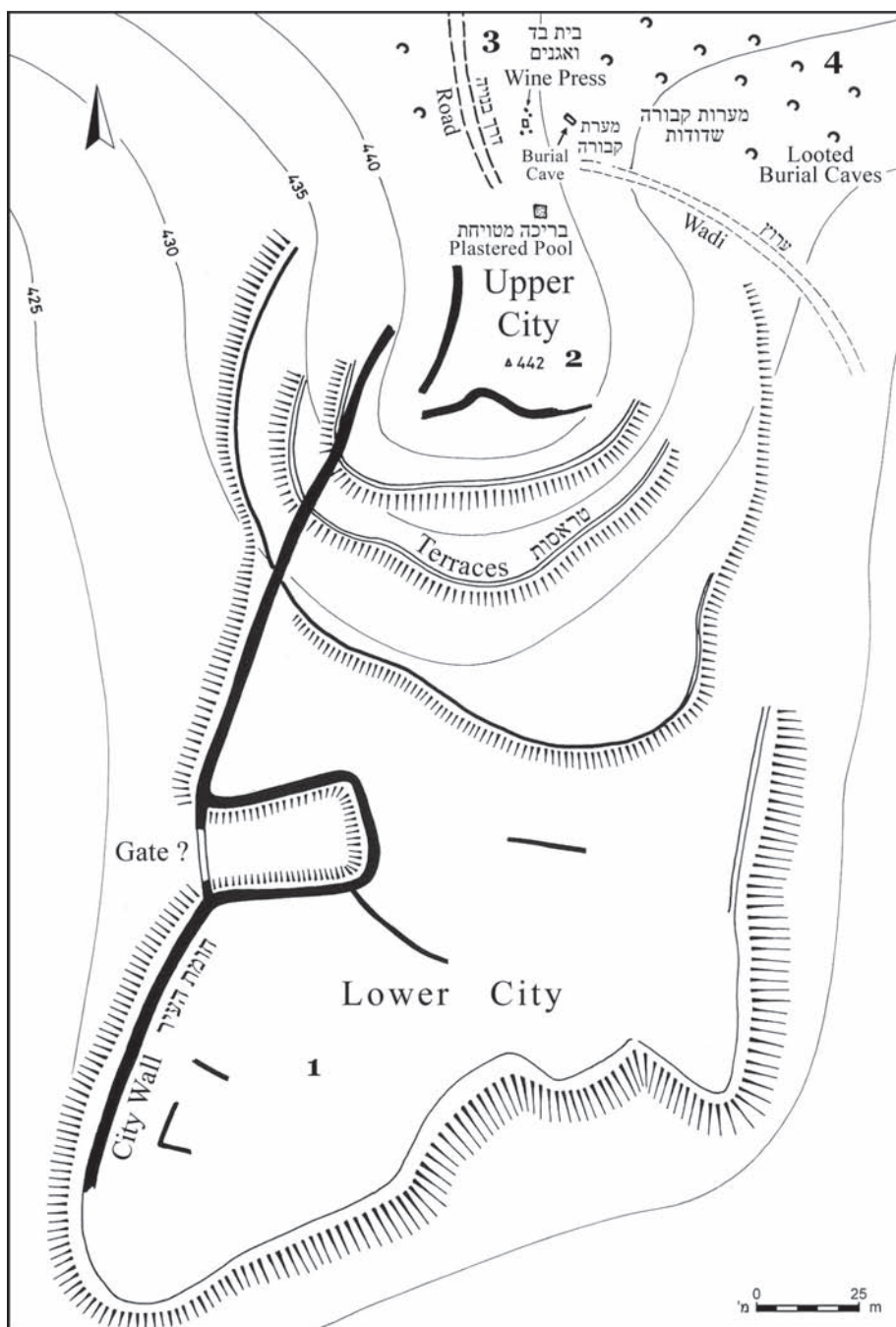
Flint find: EBA; see appendix.

This is one of the most important sites from the Early Bronze Age in the Wadi el-Far'ah area. In addition to its natural, fortified and elevated location, it is fortified by a wall and a possible gate. It is one of a group of fortified tells from this period in the valley: Tel el-Far'ah (N), er-Rjjum, el-Makhruq and possibly Wadi Umm Wattad.

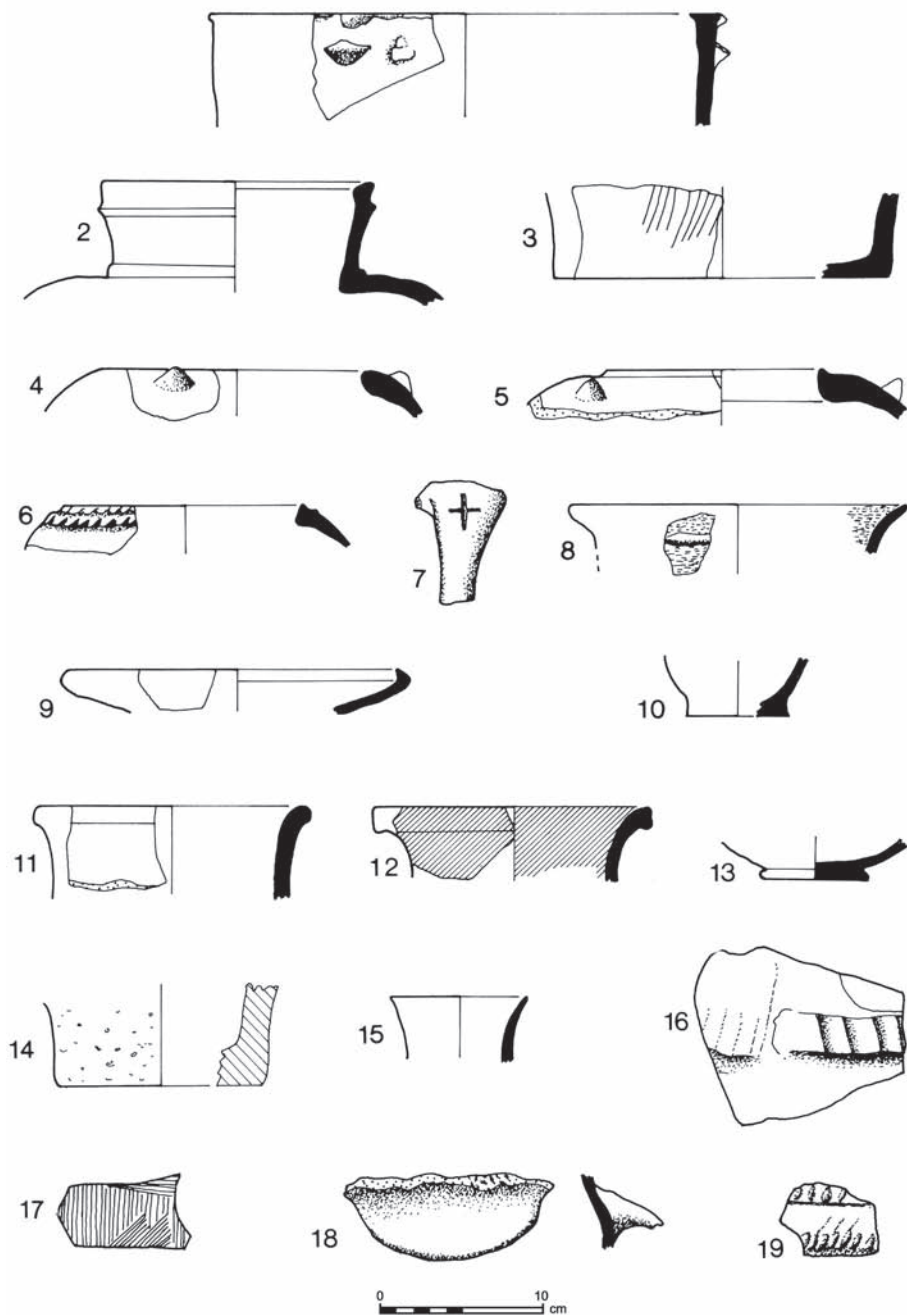
Previous surveys: none.



393. View from the southeast of the tell (at left in photo) and the lower city of Za'anuni. Winter 1994.



394. The plan of the fortified site of Tel Za'anuni. At bottom is the lower city and the place of the gate (?), with the upper tell to the north. Next to it are the industrial area and the cemetery.



395. Pottery from Tel Za'anuni: 1. Bowl, br, Neol; 2-3. Jars, yel, EBA II; 4-5. HM jars, br, Neol; 7. Jar handle, br, IrA II; 6, 8. HM jar and jar, br, 'Far'ah family'; 9. Platter, yel, EBA II; 10. Chalice base, yel, EBA; 11-12. Jars, red slip, EBA II; 13. Bowl base, yel, MBA II; 14. Basin base, basalt; 15. Small jar, lt, EBA, 16. Rope dec, br; 17. Combed dec, EBA II; 18. Ledge handle, yel, EBA I; 19. Rope dec, br, EBA.

Site 184: 18 – 18/70/1

Khirbet 'Ain Dabbur

Israel grid: 1875 1809

UTM grid: 7269 5675

Elevation: 70 m a.s.l., 5 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small site

Area: 4.2 dunams (1 acre)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;

quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain ed-Dabbur, no. 111), 0.7 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 2 km distant

Visibility: 5

Mar. 25, 1984; 49 shards

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A small site in an area built of slopes descending north from Jebel Kebir to the valley of Wadi el-Far'ah. It is about 2 km southwest of Kh. Bet Hasan, and adjacent to the spring of 'Ain Dabbur and the path ascending to Tel Za'anuni.

The site is located in a small hilltop on a slope. It stretch upon three steps of large stones, approximately aligned east – west. At least ten well-preserved structures with discernible walls were found *in situ*. Above the site is a cultivated field

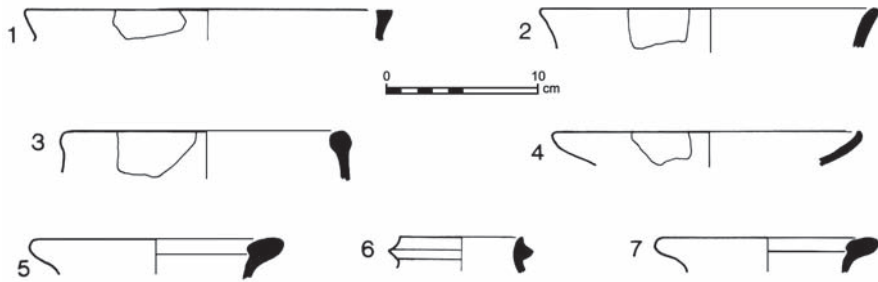


396. View from the north of the site at 'Ain Dabbur. The structural remains are on the terraces; Jebel Kebir is in the background. Winter 1984.

with many shards.

Previous surveys: none.

Pottery: MBA IIB – 100%.



397. Pottery from 'Ain Dabbur, all MBA IIB: 1-2, 4. Bowls, yellow; 3. Crater, gray; 5, 7. Jars, pinkish; 6. Jug, gray.



Site 185: 18 – 18/90/1

Jelamet el-Ahmar (C)

Israel grid: 1898 1809

UTM grid: 7281 5680

Elevation: 10 m b.s.l., 5 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: prehistoric site

Area: 3 dunams (0.75 acre)

Topography: low hilltop on plain

Rock type: alluvium covering

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 8

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 0.7 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3),
passes by site

Visibility: 4

Dec. 3, 1993; 212 flint items

A prehistoric site on a low hilltop on the cultivated plains south of Wadi el-Far'ah, about 0.6 km south of Jelamet el-Ahmar (A).

Many installations and a scatter

of flint tools and items were found on the hilltop.

Flint find: Kebaran-Geometric; see appendix.

Previous surveys: none.

Site 186: 19 – 18/10/2

Khirbet el-'Athmawiyyeh

Israel grid: 1911 1802

UTM grid: 7291 5670

Elevation: 50 m b.s.l., 20 m b.s.a.

Name type: historical site but does not appear on map

Site type: large ruin

Area: 18 dunams (4.5 acres)

Topography: valley edge and slope

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and Mediterra-

nean brown forest soil; quality: 6

Cultivation: uncultivated and field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), passes by site

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), passes by site

Visibility: 1

May 19, 1982; 38 shards

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A large site in the valley of Wadi el-Far'ah, situated on a slope delineated by a series of low cliffs, in the narrow place where the river cuts through a strip of hard rock. It is

next to the river gorge and the road to the Jordan Valley.

On the slope many structures were found *in situ*, including courtyards and walls of hewn stones. An



398. View from the east of Kh. el-'Athmawiyyeh, where the tents are set up, left of Wadi el-Far'ah and the road. In the background are Ras Bilam ez-Zef and Jebel Tammun. 1993.

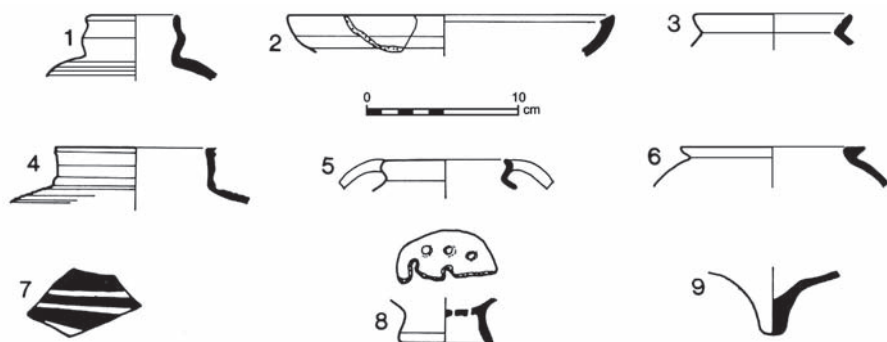
old aqueduct crosses the ruin, and burial caves in secondary use, most of them looted, are in the cliffs above and around the site. There is a modern Bedouin encampment on

the site (1993).

Pottery: Byz – 70%; EM – 30%.

Coin find: one coin; see appendix.

Previous surveys: Porath 1968, no. 91.



399. Pottery from Kh. el-Athmawiyeh: nos. 1-4, 9 – Byz; the rest – EM: 1, 4. Jars, dk; 2-3. Bowls, lt br; 5-6. CP, dk; 7. Dec shard, wh on bl; 8. jug with strainer, dk; 9. Jar base, lt.



Site 187: 19 – 18/10/1

er-Rjjum

Israel grid: 1915 1802

UTM grid: 7299 5671

Elevation: 40 m b.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: fortified city

Area: 34 dunams (8.5 acres)

Topography: ridge edge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and Mediterranean brown forest soil; quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 0.5 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 0.5 km distant

Visibility: 3

May 19, 1982; Apr. 24, 1992; 70 shards

A fortified city on a ridge isolated from its surroundings by deep gorges. The ridge is located above

and north of Wadi el-Far'ah, in the narrow, central part of the river valley.

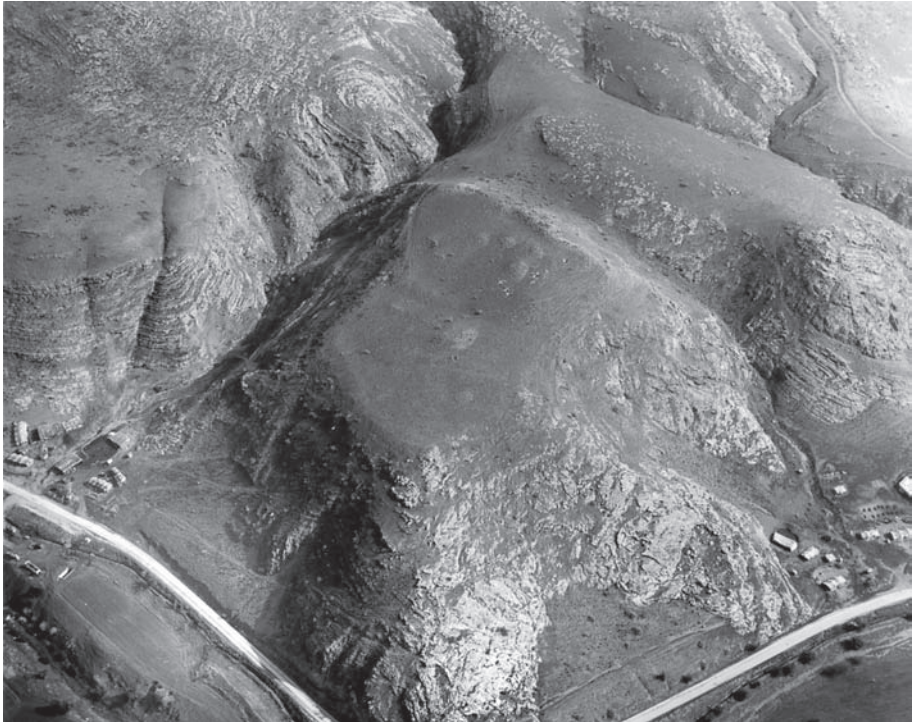
The ridge where the city is built slopes moderately southwestwards; its only connection with its environs is in the north-east, where a presumed moat is quarried, 15 m across and 3 m deep, to isolate the city from the eastern ridge.

The site is about 260 m long, 130 m wide and roughly elliptical in shape, with 'waves' of the city-wall along the topography. It was surrounded by a wide wall, 2-3 m wide on the average, which encircles the city from all its sides.

On the northeastern, higher side of the settlement, an area about 10 dunams (2.5 acres) in size is dis-

cernible; part of it may be based on the fill excavated from the moat. On this section of the place, which reminds an 'acropolis', there are important parts of the fortification: it compose the gate complex with an entrance and towers. In addition, in the northern corner of it there is a large structure, covered by pile of stones. The upper city wall, 4 m wide in this area, leaves the gate-complex toward the south. Parts of it are also covered by piles of stones.

In the northeastern corner of the high area the wide city wall divides into an upper and a lower branch;



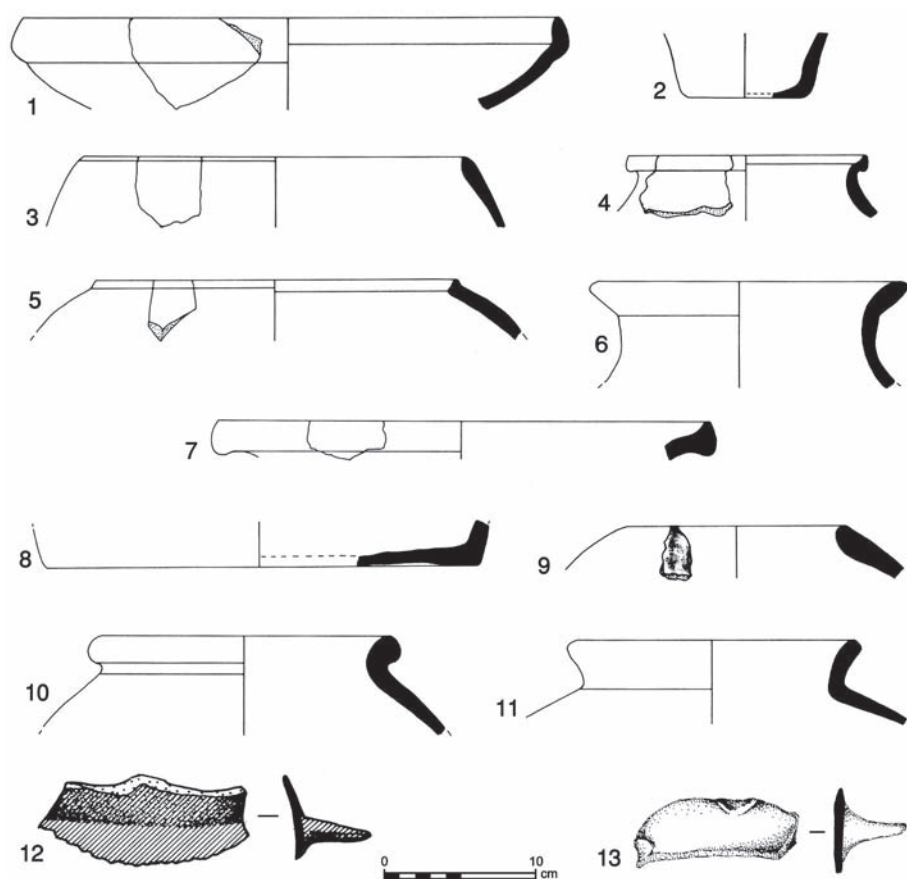
400. Aerial photo to the northeast of the Early Bronze Age city at er-Rjjum. Note the placement of the city on a ridge surrounded by deep wadis. Winter 1994.

the latter, 2 m wide, pass along the moat and connects to the city-wall in the northern corner. This part was served, presumably, as the outer fortification line in the gate-area.

Along the city-wall and inside the settlement, many structural remains *in situ* are visible. Most of them, built of field stones and pebbles, have been preserved adjacent to the wall. In the central part several large piles of stones apparently

cover structures. There are also many installations *in situ*. On the cliff, in the northwestern gorge, the remains of a built path were preserved, perhaps leading originally to the gate area.

This fortified city belongs to a special type of sites from the Early Bronze Age, presumably established at the beginning of urbanization. Nearby in the wadi there are sites from the end of the Chalco-



401. Pottery from er-Rjjum: nos. 7-8, 10, 12 – EBA I; the rest – EBA II: 1. Platter, yel; 2. Small jar base, slip; 3. HM jar, br; 4. Jar, yel; 5. HM jar, lt; 6. Jar, lt br; 7. Platter, yel; 8. Jar base, yel; 9. HM jar, yel; 10. Jar, dk; 11. Jar, dk; 12-13. Ledge handles.

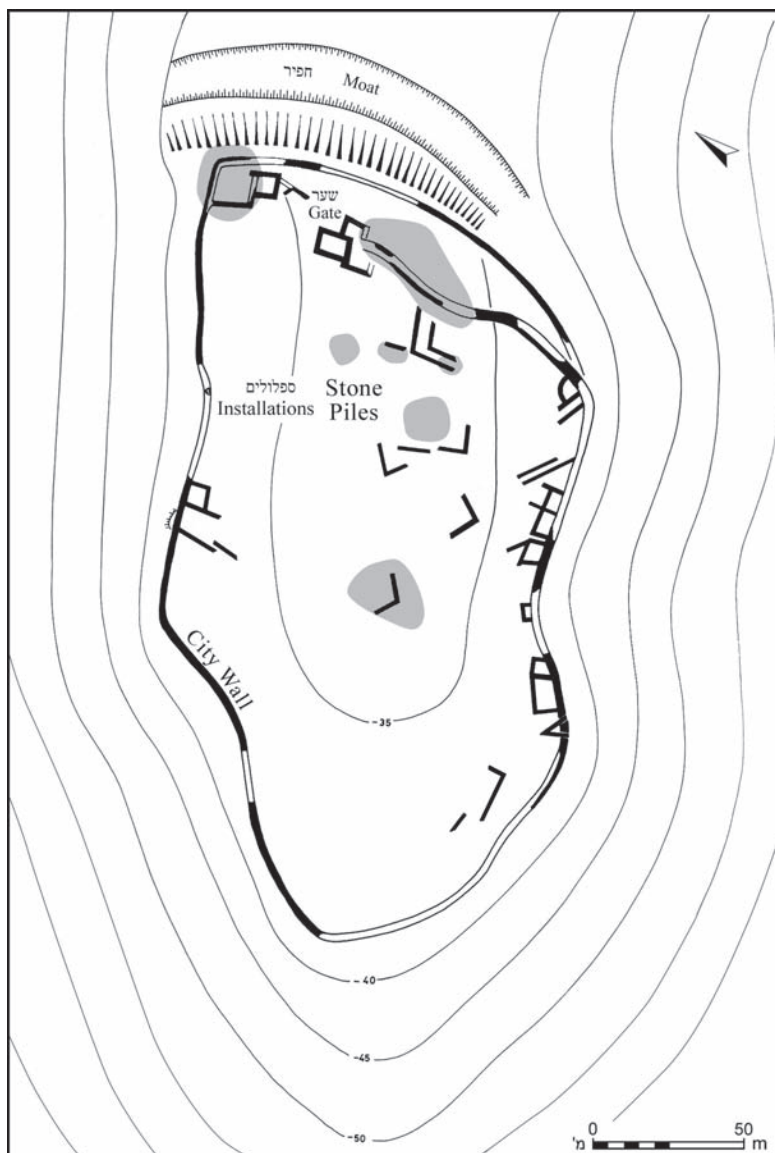
lithic Period and Early Bronze Age, which might have been the origin of the population of er-Rjjum; and see sites 178-179, 181-182 here.

Pottery: EBA I – 60%; EBA II – 40%.

Flint find: one item from an unidentified period.

Previous surveys: Porath 1968, no. 88.

Bibliography: Zertal 1993.



402. Plan of the fortified, Early Bronze Age city at er-Rjjum. In the northeast the double wall, the moat and the gate-complex are seen.